E-Safety and Acceptable Use Policy

1. Introduction
This policy is designed to promote a safe, responsible, and respectful environment for use of digital technology within the school community. It supports the school's mission to develop confident, responsible digital citizens who understand the importance of safeguarding themselves and others online, while also respecting legal and ethical standards.

2. Digital Citizenship
Digital citizenship encompasses the responsible use of technology, recognizing the rights and responsibilities of individuals in the online space. This includes respecting others' work and opinions, avoiding cyberbullying, and understanding that online actions can have real-world consequences. All students and staff are expected to act with integrity and kindness in all digital environments. Education on digital citizenship is integrated across the curriculum through lessons, assemblies, and extracurricular activities to promote awareness and positive behavior.

3. Acceptable Use of Technology
School-provided devices, internet access, and platforms are intended solely for educational purposes and operational requirements. Users must follow the guidance to ensure responsible usage:

Allowed Use: Accessing educational content, researching topics, submitting assignments, communicating with teachers and classmates for academic purposes, and supporting school administration.

Prohibited Use: Accessing or sharing inappropriate or offensive content (pornography, hate speech, extremist material), participating in cyberbullying or harassment, downloading unapproved software or content, or attempting to bypass security filters.

Guidelines: Users should respect copyright laws, avoid sharing personal information about themselves or others, and ensure their online activity reflects positively on the school.

4. E-Safety Education
A comprehensive, progressive e-safety curriculum is embedded within the school's wider educational programs. It adapts to students' age and maturity levels, teaching essential skills such as:

Recognizing online risks and understanding how to stay safe.

Developing a positive digital footprint.

Understanding privacy settings and managing personal information.

Identifying and responding to cyberbullying and unsafe online behaviors.

Using social media responsibly and recognizing misinformation.
Regular reviews and updates ensure the curriculum remains relevant and impactful.

5. Safeguarding and Reporting

Maintaining a safe online environment depends on swift identification and response to concerns. All school staff and students are encouraged to report issues such as cyberbullying, exposure to harmful content, or inappropriate online contact. The school has clear procedures for reporting concerns confidentially, which are communicated regularly through assemblies, notices, and safety guides. Support mechanisms are in place to assist those affected, and investigations are conducted promptly, following safeguarding protocols.

6. Parental Involvement

Parents and carers play a pivotal role in reinforcing e-safety at home. The school will offer guidance, workshops, and resources to help families understand online risks and responsible practices. The Acceptable Use Agreement will be shared and signed by all parents/carers and students. Parental consent is required for capturing or sharing images of students, ensuring compliance with data protection laws and respecting privacy rights.

7. Staff Responsibilities

Teachers and staff are expected to serve as positive role models online, demonstrating appropriate digital behavior during their interactions with students and colleagues. They must monitor student use of school devices, supervise online activities, and address concerns swiftly. Staff are also responsible for maintaining their own digital literacy and staying informed about the latest e-safety practices through ongoing training.

8. Monitoring and Filtering

FRAM School prioritizes a safe and responsible online environment for all students. To achieve this, we employ a multi-layered approach to monitoring and filtering internet access, designed to minimize exposure to inappropriate or harmful content.

Filtering Tools: We utilize [insert what is applicable] filtering tools to restrict access to websites and content that are deemed inappropriate for a school setting. These filters are regularly updated to address emerging online threats and are configured to align with our school's values and educational goals.

Internet Monitoring Software: Our internet monitoring software [insert what is applicable] helps us to detect and respond to misuse of school technology, such as attempts to access prohibited websites or engage in cyberbullying.

Regular Audits: We conduct regular audits of our filtering and monitoring systems to ensure their effectiveness and identify any areas for improvement.

Transparent Boundaries: While monitoring is essential for protecting our community, we are also committed to respecting user privacy. We operate within transparent boundaries, ensuring that students and staff are aware of the school's monitoring practices and the reasons behind them. The purpose of monitoring is not to intrude on privacy, but to create a safe and secure online learning environment.

Balanced Approach: We strive to strike a balance between safety and trust. While we actively monitor internet usage, we also focus on educating students about responsible online behavior, critical thinking skills, and digital citizenship.

Logs: System logs are regularly reviewed to help identify and respond to potential security threats or policy violations. Access to these logs is restricted to authorized personnel.

9. Data Protection

FRAM School is committed to protecting the privacy and personal data of all members of our school community. We comply with all relevant data protection legislation, including the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and any applicable national laws. Any storage, use, or sharing of personal data; such as photographs, contact details, medical information, and wellbeing records, must follow strict protocols.

Data Minimization: We only collect personal data that is necessary for legitimate educational and administrative purposes.

Purpose Limitation: Personal data will only be used for the specific purpose for which it was collected and will not be used for any other purpose without consent, unless required by law.

Data Security: We implement appropriate technical and organizational measures to protect personal data from unauthorized access, use, disclosure, alteration, or destruction. These measures include:

Secure storage of electronic data with password protection and access controls.

Secure storage of paper-based records in locked cabinets with limited access.

Regular data backups and disaster recovery procedures.

Employee training on data protection and security best practices.

Data Retention: Personal data will be retained only for as long as necessary to fulfill the purpose for which it was collected, or as required by law. We have established data retention schedules for different types of data.

Data Access and Rectification: Individuals have the right to access their personal data and to request that any inaccurate or incomplete data be corrected. Requests for access or rectification should be directed to [Specify contact person or department].

Parental Consent: Parental consent will be obtained for any use of student images or other personal data for external purposes, such as on the school website, in marketing materials, or in media releases. Parents have the right to withdraw their consent at any time.

Authorized Personnel: Access to personal data is restricted to authorized personnel who have a legitimate need to know the information in order to perform their job duties. All staff members are required to sign a confidentiality agreement.

Data Sharing Agreements: When sharing personal data with third-party service providers (e.g., online learning platforms, cloud storage providers), we will enter into data processing agreements to ensure that the service providers comply with data protection legislation.

Data Breach Notification: In the event of a data breach, we will notify the relevant authorities and affected individuals in accordance with GDPR requirements.

10. Specific Policy Elements

Photography and Videography:
Personal devices should not be used to take photos or videos during lessons unless explicitly authorized by staff. School-taken images are stored securely, and sharing externally requires prior parental consent. The school's media policies ensure images are handled ethically and legally.

Mobile Phone Use:
Students should turn off and store phones in lockers or their belongings during lessons to prevent distractions. Teachers have the authority to permit limited use for educational tasks; otherwise, phones should be kept silent and out of sight. Staff are expected to manage and enforce these guidelines consistently.

Social Media:
Both students and staff must understand the boundaries of professional and personal social media use. Interactions with students should remain appropriate and transparent. The school's social media platforms are monitored to ensure they promote positive engagement

11. Incident Management and Sanctions

The school is committed to ensuring that any breaches of the E-Safety and Acceptable Use Policy are dealt with promptly, fairly, and consistently. When an incident occurs - such as cyberbullying, accessing inappropriate content, or misuse of devices - it should be reported immediately to a designated e-safety coordinator or senior staff member.

Once reported, the school will undertake an investigation following safeguarding protocols, respecting confidentiality at all times. Appropriate sanctions will be applied depending on the severity and nature of the breach, which may include verbal or written warnings, restriction of device access, detention, or in serious cases, suspension or exclusion.

Additionally, preventative measures, such as further training or disciplinary reviews, may be implemented to reinforce responsible behavior. The school aims to support and educate students about digital responsibilities rather than solely focus on punishment, fostering a culture of awareness and correction.